



Roots & Wings

INDIANAPOLIS

Roots and Wings Homeschool Inc.

Member Handbook

Updated 7/2026



Welcome

We're glad you're here. Contained in this document are the basics of Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. It is not all-inclusive but it is a great place to start and to come back to during your tenure with our community. Take a look around and reach out to us should you have any questions.

Mission and Goals Statements

Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. is a 501c3 non-profit organization of homeschooled families in and around Indianapolis building a diverse, secular, inclusive community.

Our Mission

Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. consists of homeschooling families from the greater Indianapolis area working together to provide classes, activities, and other educational and social opportunities in a quality, secular, and inclusive environment, in which children are nurtured in a climate of mutual respect.

Inclusivity Statement

Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. co-op is committed to creating an environment in which everyone's dignity is respected. Toward our goal of building a diverse, secular, inclusive community, we will not tolerate discrimination on the basis of race, color, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, class, religious affiliation or non-affiliation, age, parental or marital status, veteran status, national or ethnic origin, legal status, political beliefs, or physical or mental status. We are dedicated to fostering an empathetic, compassionate, and socially responsible community.



Location Information and Regulations

Our Space

Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. meets at First Mennonite Church (FMC) on the northwest side of Indianapolis. We are honored to be guests of FMC. In order to maintain an excellent relationship with the church members and leaders, we are committed to treating the facility with respect, which includes:

- Leaving the facility cleaner than we find it each week
- Always cleaning up our own messes
- Emptying trash cans in classrooms and lunchrooms and taking trash to dumpster
- Putting tables and chairs back as we found them
- Sweeping and vacuuming floors as needed
- Wiping down tables as needed
- Walking, not running, in the building
- Using our indoor voices out of respect for church personnel who may be present
- Volunteering our time for various work and charity projects throughout the year
- Ensuring students always have adult supervision when upstairs
- Students should only be upstairs to attend an assigned class.

Tobacco, drugs, alcoholic beverages, and firearms are prohibited in the building and on the premises of FMC.

Guidelines for use of FMC facilities are on pages 22-24 of the FMC handbook, available [here](#).

Building and Grounds Use

Please use the rear entrance of the building for arrival and departure. These are the double doors closest to the playground. Roots and Wings Members are not to use the main doors of the building.

Roots and Wings Members are permitted access to the classrooms, kitchen, kitchen annex, multipurpose room, fellowship hall, and bathrooms inside the building (see Building Map).



Outside the building Members are permitted to access the playground, the garage/pavilion, and the green spaces immediately surrounding the playground.

Students may access the upstairs portion of the building during class times and only with adult supervision. Students may only access the lawn to the west of the building, behind the building, the far side of the pond, and the area east of the playground down the path (Memorial Garden) with adult supervision (i.e. for classes). No Member (adult or student) may go inside the fenced area at the pond without the express prior approval of the Board. Such approval will only be granted under special, class-specific circumstances.

Property Damage

The cost of damage done intentionally or through gross negligence to church or co-op property will be borne by the individuals/individuals' families who created the damage. All other damage will be assessed on an event-by-event basis with an understanding of the actual cause of the damage.

Building Map and Room Assignments

See the end of this document for a map of the FMC building. Room names are listed on the map and may be used for locating classes, supplies, etc.

Conduct and Behavior

Code of Conduct

All co-op Members are expected to conduct themselves with respect, self-control, responsibility, and accountability to themselves, others, and the facility and grounds.

Specifically, the following behaviors are not acceptable:

- Violence or aggression, either physical, verbal, or otherwise
- Bullying
- Discrimination
- Behavior that disrupts the classroom focus



- Using cell phones or other electronic devices for personal or recreational reasons in class (see policy)
- Children leaving a classroom without permission
- Adults leaving a class unattended
- Cursing/foul language
- Damage to church or private property, both interior and exterior
- Behavior that violates a person's or family's boundaries

It is imperative that all co-op Members, adults and children, understand and comply with the above expectations. Adult Members should discuss the Code of Conduct and make sure that their child(ren) understands these expectations.

For children who need help staying on task during co-op classes, after other strategies have been exhausted, parents may be asked by the Class Leader to join the class to shadow their child and help their child stay focused and minimize disruptions.

Given the informal and friendly nature of our co-op, it is expected that Members will address any conflict directly with the people involved in a respectful manner and try to reach a resolution. If, after this, the conflict is still unresolved, mediation may be utilized.

Mediation

Conflict can occur within a large group. Should co-op Members find themselves engaged in a conflict that is not easily resolved a member may request mediation. Please review these guidelines for the mediation process.

Prior to mediation:

- If necessary, allow time for cooling down
- Arrange to direct your concern to the party involved in a private area. Communications need to be respectful, with the goal of no shame or blame. Active listening is encouraged
- Limit communication regarding the conflict to those directly involved. Communication that is kept to only the parties involved will ensure privacy for all and prevent gossip and escalation of conflict



Conflict that cannot be resolved with the above measures may be presented to the Board for further mediation. The Board will arrange for a mediator to meet with the parties involved to help resolve the conflict.

For questions regarding our Mediation Policy, or to request a Board Member for mediation, please email Board@rootsandwingsindy.com.

Buddy Bench

The rainbow colored bench on the east side of the playground is used by Roots and Wings Members as the Buddy Bench. The purpose of the Buddy Bench is to provide a simple avenue for all members to connect with each other. Members are encouraged to use the Buddy Bench as follows:

- Anyone needing a “buddy” (friend to play with) can sit on the Buddy Bench
- Anyone who sees a Member sitting on the Buddy Bench should approach that Member and invite them to play/join in their game/take a walk, etc.
- The Member sitting on the Buddy Bench should accept the offer

Schedules, Fees, and Class Information

Day-to-Day Operations

Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc. co-op meets during the fall and spring for five sessions each school year. Each session consists of five weeks of classes, followed by two weeks off: one week for special events or field trips, and one week for a break.

Classes meet on Wednesdays from 9:45 AM - 3:00 PM and are divided into morning blocks and afternoon blocks, with a lunch break in between.

The day's schedule is as follows*:

9:30 AM

- Doors open. Families should arrive between 9:30 and 9:45 AM.

9:45 AM



- Families gather in the Fellowship Hall for conversation and morning announcements. It is important to be present and attentive at this time.

9:50 AM

- Morning announcements in the Fellowship Hall.

10:00 AM - 12:00 PM

- Morning classes. The class leads will walk the students to their respective classrooms.

12:00 - 12:45 PM

- Lunch and free time. Lunch may be consumed in the Fellowship Hall, the Kitchen Annex, the Multipurpose Room, or outside in permitted areas.
- Families provide their own lunches, dishes, and utensils.
- There are refrigerators and microwaves on site to keep and warm your food; however, the stoves are only available for adult use.
- Members are responsible for washing and putting away their own dishes and cleaning up their own table and floor around the table.
- Weather depending, students will either have free time on the playground or an activity in the Fellowship Hall.
- Students should not be in classrooms during free time.

12:45 - 12:55 PM

- Clean-up and set-up for afternoon classes.

12:55 PM

- Afternoon announcements in the Fellowship Hall.

1:00 - 1:55 PM

- Block 1 of afternoon classes.

2:00 - 2:55 PM

- Block 2 of afternoon classes.

3:00 - 3:20 PM

- Families should remove their personal belongings, including all take-home projects from classes.
- Class Leads should remove or properly store their class materials.
- Classroom Assistants should clean up from afternoon classes.
- The Cleaning Crew will clean the building.

3:25 PM

- Building Closer will do a final walkthrough of the building, close and lock doors. All Members must vacate the building by this time.

*subject to change



Class Fees

Class fees* are \$10 per child, per session for morning classes and \$10 per child, per session for afternoon classes. Class fees cover the cost of class-specific materials and go directly to the class your child(ren) is taking each session.

Member Fees

Member fees* vary depending on the number of Member families in any given semester. They are paid twice per year, at the beginning of each semester, and typically range from \$35-\$45 per family, per semester. Member fees cover the operational costs of running the co-op: rent, insurance, website maintenance, and basic supply inventory. Class and Member fees for the entire semester (generally 10 or 15 weeks) will be due before the first day of the session, as determined by the Finance Committee.

*All class and member fees paid are nonrefundable

Class Sizes

Morning class size is generally capped at 12 students per class. Some years some classes are kept smaller because of a smaller classroom and some classes are allowed to go over on a case-by-case basis. The morning classes are divided into the following groups*:

1. Greenhouse (ages 0-2, no programming)
2. Saplings (ages 3-5)
3. Sassafras (ages 5-6)
4. Oaks (ages 7-8)
5. Maples (ages 8-9)
6. Willows (ages 10-11)
7. Birch (11-12)
8. Cedars (ages 12-13)
9. Pigeons (ages 14+)

*Subject to change yearly



Afternoon classes are somewhat more flexible on both sizes and age-ranges.

Class Policies

Roots and Wings Homeschool Co-op, Inc. provides programming for students who are ages 3-18 years old at the start of the co-op year. Member families with students both inside and outside of that age-range may attend co-op with the acknowledgement that programming will only be provided for their student(s) inside the programming age-range. Families who only have students outside of the programming age-range will not be considered for Membership.

Morning classes are pre-assigned, according to age, by the Membership Chair (see morning class groupings above). There is no sign-up for morning classes.

Afternoon classes are typically designed for ages 3-6, 7-11, 12+, and Multiage. Afternoon classes are interest-based. Students will need to be signed up for afternoon classes based on their particular interest in classes available each session. Afternoon class sign-up opens a few weeks before the start of each session and will remain open for one week. Some classes fill up quickly. If a class sign-up goes over the allotted number of slots all students signed-up for that class will be entered into a lottery. Students who do not gain entrance into that class will be placed into their second choice class.

Students wishing to take part in an afternoon class outside of their age-range may do so, space permitting, with the approval of the Class Lead.

Being on time to classes is essential to the smooth running of co-op and shows respect to fellow Members. Adults should be mindful of this and help their child(ren) get to classes on time. Class Leads and Classroom Assistants should be mindful of the time and begin clean-up at a time that ensures children may be dismissed on time and the next class can begin setting up.

Cell phones and other personal electronic devices should not be used during class time by adults or students.



General Policies

Communication

Roots and Wings uses the Members' Website and Google Workspaces for its main methods of communication between current Members. Each Member Family will receive a @RootsandWingsIndy email address upon joining the co-op. Within Google Workspace there are multiple chat spaces and they do fluctuate from year to year, depending on co-op needs. Members should take note of, and make an effort to regularly check the website and the following chat spaces, specifically:

Announcements

This space is reserved for the sharing of special or important information pertinent to all Members. Posting privileges are reserved for Board Members and others as the Board deems appropriate..

Lost and Found

This space is reserved for posts announcing items found in and around the FMC building on co-op days.

Class-Specific Space(s)

These spaces are intended to facilitate communication between parents who have students in morning classes together. The Morning Class Liaisons moderate these spaces.

Members will have access to their Member email address and Google Workspace as long as they are current Members. Once a Member Family withdraws, or otherwise leaves co-op, access will be terminated after a period of 2-weeks. For non-returning co-op members, access will be terminated at the end of summer before the new co-op season begins.

Safety

Each school year a member of Roots and Wings serves as a designated Safety Officer. Concerns about safety should be directed to the Safety Officer (see Committee Roles).



Severe Weather

Lightning

In the event of thunder or lightning all families should be called inside until the risk of lightning has passed.

Tornado Warning

In the event of a tornado warning, adults should lead students to the interior of the building, ideally into interior restrooms and storage rooms/closets closest to their classroom. Avoid rooms with windows or large open spaces, such as the fellowship hall, as they are not safe in a tornado.

Weather-Related Closings

Because Roots & Wings Homeschool, Inc. co-op meets in the Washington Township area we follow Washington Township's weather-related school closings. If Washington Township cancels school due to weather or road conditions, co-op will be canceled for that day. If they have a weather-related delay, co-op will still meet at the regular time. Please monitor announcements in the media for Washington Township closings.

We know that many of our families live outside the Washington Township area and that some travel quite a distance to attend co-op. Families must use their personal judgment on whether to attend co-op if the weather or roads are worse in their area than they are in the Washington Township area. If co-op is running but your family cannot attend, please notify the group and secure any responsibility coverage.

Because there is a minimum number of adults needed to run a full day of co-op, the Board may put out a survey to determine expected attendance when severe weather is forecasted. Please watch for weather related attendance surveys and fill them out promptly.



Allergies

Since allergies can be life-threatening, it is important to avoid sharing any foods with other children without the express consent of their parents or guardians first. If your child has an allergy, sensitivity, or dietary restriction (vegan, kosher, etc.), please let your Classroom Liaison know so they can inform Class Leads and parents of students in your child(ren)'s class.

Adults should keep allergens current in the Member Directory.

Pronouns

Roots and Wings is an inclusive community. We respect all peoples' pronouns. Class Liaisons will work with Class Leads and Classroom Assistants to ensure students' pronouns are known prior to the start of each session.

Adults should keep pronouns current in the Member Directory.

First Aid

A first aid kit is centrally located in the storage closet and is available for use by all co-op Members and guests. The Safety Officer will keep the first aid kit stocked and in-date.

Fire

There are fire extinguishers in the foyer, Fellowship Hall, middle classrooms, kitchen, and in the halls outside the library, multipurpose room, nursery, and the stairwell. In the event of a fire alarm, proceed to the nearest exit and meet at the playground. Fire alarms are located near the interior doors of the rear entrance and near the door to the kitchen.

Illness Guidelines

Common sense prevails when deciding whether it is wise to attend co-op on any given day. If anyone in your household has a contagious illness, no one in your family should attend co-op that day.



Illnesses such as pinkeye, scabies, head lice, impetigo, strep infection, whooping cough, measles, mumps, chickenpox, Covid-19, and common colds and flus are highly contagious. It is therefore the policy of Roots & Wings co-op that no youth or parent attends the co-op with any known or recently developed infectious illness. Listed below are signs of illness that should indicate a family should not attend co-op:

- Fever above 100 degrees Fahrenheit
- Any fever within the previous 24 hours*
- Signs of possible severe illness such as uncontrolled coughing, difficulty breathing, wheezing, persistent crying, or lethargy
- Vomiting. Once a youth has vomited, most health providers recommend or require that youth not return to a group setting for at least twenty-four hours
- Any sort of rash, especially when accompanied by a fever or behavior change

If any member of your family is feeling unwell prior to attending co-op, please consider symptoms carefully and the risk they present to the group. Members of our group may be compromised by pre-existing chronic illness, immune suppression, or pregnancy. We are not just individuals, but a community that needs to care for and consider each other.

*In case of fever, all family Members should be fever free for 24 hours without the use of fever reducers prior to attending co-op.

Animal Policy

Pets of any size or type are not permitted on the premises of FMC. Registered service animals are permitted with prior notification. Please email board@rootsandwingsindy.com for more information.

Adult-Student Communications

Mentoring between adults and students is supported and encouraged; however best practices are that all outside communication between adults and students will include or be made through the student's parent or guardian.



Adult-Student Interactions

To ensure the safety and security of all co-op Members best practices should be followed when non-guardian adults are in rooms with students:

- No one-on-one interactions with students with doors closed in any confined space (aside from guardians with their own children)
- At least two adults should be assigned to and present in each class
- If assigned adults must leave the classroom, leaving only one adult present, then the door must remain open
- Bathrooms should be used in the following manner:
 - Young children have single stall bathrooms in their classrooms that they can use independently
 - Older young children can use the individual bathrooms in the back hallway with an adult monitoring from the open classroom doorway
 - Older students can use the bathroom independently after checking in with a classroom adult
 - If a student needs to be escorted to a bathroom (for instance during outside playtime), an adult may do so while monitoring from the hall nearest the bathroom appropriate to the student's age.

Substituting and Visiting Adults

In the event that the primary Roots and Wings adult is unable to attend co-op, another adult family member may attend in their place. If another family member will be in attendance, the expectation is that the substituting adult will actively participate to assist in the running of our day. Please also notify co-op using the co-op's chat space titled Absence Alert so that all Members can be aware that an unfamiliar adult will be in the building that week.

If a visiting adult (such as a grandparent) will be in attendance with the primary co-op adult, still please provide notice through Absence Alert.

All substituting and visiting persons must sign a release/waiver prior to attending co-op. Waivers are available through the Members' website or in the supply closet. Physical forms should be returned to the Communications Chair.



Membership Information

Member Requirements

In order to be considered an active and voting member of Roots and Wings Homeschool, Inc., according to the bylaws, Members must:

1. Have Member fees be current to the semester and paid-in-full
2. Complete and sign the Member Agreement and Waivers form annually. They may be returned to the Communications Director in person or via email at communications@rootsandwingsindy.com
3. Have annual registration forms completed and submitted prior to attending co-op

Member Expectations

Roots and Wings functions with a true cooperative model in that all Members volunteer their time in a variety of ways to ensure the smooth running of the organization. Having all the programming, cleaning, and administrative responsibilities performed by the Membership also helps to keep the costs to Members relatively low as compared to other homeschool co-ops in the area.

The following are in addition to the Code of Conduct (see above) and should be reviewed by all Members (adults and students) prior to attending Roots and Wings Co-op:

- Communication must be open, specific, and respectful
- Discuss any special behavioral or learning issues with your child's Class Lead and the appropriate Class Liaison prior to the co-op session in order to identify special circumstances and recommend accommodations, if any are needed
- Remain on the premises for the duration of the co-op day. For any planned recurring absences due to medical reasons, please contact Board@rootsandwingsindy.com for approval
- If anyone in the household has a known or recently developed contagious illness then everyone in the household must stay home
- Existing adult Members will hold either a two-year position, a one-year position, or serve as a special event coordinator every year



- Adult Members will lead at least 2 classes each year and may be asked to lead more than the minimum, depending on class needs
- Adult Members will volunteer to be on the Cleaning Crew* for at least 2 sessions every year
- Adult Members will volunteer to Lead, Assist, or Float each of the 4 active hours (10:00-11:00, 11:00-12:00, 1:00-2:00, 2:00-3:00)** each session
- Adults should retrieve their child(ren) promptly at the end of the designated co-op time.
- All Members should vacate the building by 3:25 PM
- Adults should limit personal conversations to outside of instructional class time
- All Members (adults and students) should refrain from having cell phones or other electronic devices out during class time. Personal electronic devices should only be used for co-op-related needs or for urgent family business (e.g. emergencies)

*Those leading afternoon classes need not volunteer for the Cleaning Crew in that same session.

**There are a limited number of prep-periods/Board work periods available each session. Those leading morning classes will be given priority for prep-periods. Board work periods are reserved for Board members.

Leave of Absence

Keeping in mind that long term absences are disruptive to the functioning of co-op and the continual building of community at Roots and Wings, we understand that flexibility is in the nature of homeschooling.

On occasion a family may need to take a leave of absence. A leave of absence may be taken for up to one semester, however the Member family will still be responsible for paying Member and class fees for the semester that they are taking leave in order to keep their Membership current (see above).

Any leave of absence (semester or session) will require at least three weeks notice to the Board of Directors and Morning Class Liaison(s).



Volunteer Requirements and Roles

All Roots & Wings co-op families are expected to contribute to the running of the co-op. There are no paid positions. We all volunteer our time.

Volunteer roles are broken down into the following categories:

Session-Long Commitments (Active Hours)

- Class Leaders
 - Lead either morning or afternoon class. This can be teaching a subject, heading a club-like class, or leading an activity-based class
- Classroom Assistants
 - Assists leads in class as needed and tidies the classroom after the class
- Cleaning Crew
 - A team of 10 Members who work to get the building cleaned up at the end of our co-op day
- Floaters
 - Are “on-call” to cover absences in the above 3 positions

One-Year Commitments

- Facility Committee
 - Responsible for maintaining relationships with the FMC staff, opening and closing the building, ensuring building is cleaned after use, ensuring all safety policies and procedures are adhered to, and coordinating volunteer work for the facility.
 - Consists of: Board President (Chair), Building Opener, Building Closer/Lost & Found, Safety Coordinator, Cleaning Crew Liaison
- Programming Committee
 - Responsible for class planning each session at all levels. This committee works together to support Class Leads, Assistants, and students.
 - Consists of: Board Vice-President (Chair), Morning Class Liaisons (one per class), Afternoon Class Liaison(s)
- Finance Committee



- Responsible for managing the co-op's finances, including collecting member and class fees, managing the checking account, giving financial reports, fundraising, stocking supplies, and coordinating co-op field trips.
 - Consists of: Board Treasurer (Chair), Fundraising Coordinator, Supply Coordinator, Field Trip Coordinator
- Membership Committee
 - Responsible for recruiting new Members, registering students for morning classes, and welcoming new Members.
 - Consists of: Board Membership Director (Chair), Welcome Coordinator, Public Communications
- Communications Committee
 - Responsible for overseeing private member communications (currently through the Members' Website and Google Workspace), member surveys, yearbook coordination, and the Board newsletter.
 - Consists of: Board Communications Director (Chair), Yearbook Coordinator
- Administrative Committee
 - Responsible for taking and keeping official meeting minutes, filing government-required paperwork, and maintaining organizational files and archives.
 - Consists of: Board Secretary (Chair), Archives Coordinator, Administration/Organization Coordinator
- Support Committee
 - Responsible for providing perspective as a long-standing member, member retention and satisfaction, and providing support for special event planning.
 - Consists of: Board Sustaining Director (Chair), Summer Social Events Liaison, Parent Social Events Liaison, Gratitude/Encouragement Coordinator, Special Event Liaison and Community Liaison.

Two-Year Commitments

- Board Members
 - President
 - Vice President
 - Treasurer
 - Secretary
 - Communications Director



- Membership Director
 - Sustaining Director
- Board Members are elected by a majority vote of the Membership every 2-years, per the organizational bylaws (see below).

Semester/Event Commitments

- Special Event Coordinator
 - Works with a team of Special Events Planning Support members to plan, organize, and implement all aspects of the event.
 - Supported by the Special Events Liaison
- Special Event Planning Support
 - Assist to plan, organize, and implement all aspects of the event.
 - Supported by the Special Event Coordinator

A detailed description of all volunteer roles, along with a list of who is currently fulfilling each role, can be found on the Member website. . If, for any reason, a member is unable to complete their volunteer commitment, the member must communicate with the Committee Chair as soon as possible and work with the Chair to fill their position with another Member.

Attendance Policy

Regular attendance is expected. In addition to learning new things, the purpose of co-op is to build a community/network of families who know and support each other. Class Leads often spend a great deal of time planning and preparing materials for students. Some class activities depend on all Members of the class being present. It is respectful to all Members for everyone to strive for perfect attendance each session.

Late arrivals are disruptive. Please plan to arrive at FMC by 9:45 AM.

Occasional adult absences where student(s) attend with another co-op Member taking responsibility for that student(s) may be approved by the Board on a case-by-case basis. Members must email the Board to gain said approval. However, we are a cooperative and an adult is required to be present each week for each family. Consistent guardian absences may result in loss of Membership for the family.



Absence Policy

Adults who have a planned absence should reach out to the Class Leads or, if the absent adult is the Lead, the Classroom Assistants to determine whether or not coverage is needed. If coverage is needed, the absent adult should secure coverage for their active hour positions (see Member Expectations). Once coverage has been secured the absent party should inform all interested parties about who will be covering their role(s) for that day.

Floater are responsible for monitoring announced absences and volunteering for coverage when available.

Visitor and Guest Policy

Roots and Wings is a small, private co-op. Tours and visits by interested families must be arranged in advance with the Membership Director and will be scheduled at the convenience of the co-op.

In general, guest students are not permitted to attend co-op. This includes regular co-op days and co-op special events and field trips, unless otherwise specified. If any current co-op Member wishes to bring a guest to a co-op day, special event, or field trip, they must request authorization from the Board of Directors at least 2 weeks in advance of the guest's requested attendance date. Guests are expected to follow all Roots & Wings Member Expectations, Code of Conduct, Rules, Policies, and Procedures and must sign a liability waiver before attending co-op.

Withdrawal Policy

Members may withdraw from Roots and Wings at any time. When a Member family wishes to withdraw, they should notify the Membership Director of the intended withdrawal and include their last anticipated day of attendance/participation and any outstanding duties that would need to be covered in their absence. Members must also pay any outstanding balances of Member and/or Class Fees upon withdrawing from Roots and Wings.



Financial Policies

Checking Account

The Finance Committee Chair (Treasurer) and one other Board Member (typically the President) will be designated as authorized signers for the checking account at any given time. Bank signature cards will be updated within two weeks of the Board change over. Fees for Member's personal checks that are returned for insufficient funds will be paid by the Member. The checkbook will be balanced each month by the Treasurer within three weeks of the statement date and reviewed by at least one other member of the Board within six weeks of the statement date.

Collection of Fees

Membership and class fees will be collected by the Treasurer and may be paid via cash, check or PayPal.

Fundraising profit and Field Trip fees will be collected by the event organizer who will deliver the funds with a list of payees to the Treasurer within five days of receipt. The Treasurer will deposit the funds in the co-op checking account. The Collector will issue a written receipt for any cash or money orders received and submit a copy of the receipt to the Treasurer for reconciliation.

Financial Assistance

Members experiencing financial hardship may contact the Finance Committee Chair (Treasurer) by August 1st and December 1st proceeding the semester in which they are seeking assistance for class fees. In order to qualify for class fee financial assistance Members must:

1. Pay the member fees for the semester in which assistance is being requested
2. Request a percent (10%-100%) of class fees to be paid for the semester in writing to the Board Treasurer

The Finance Committee Chair will review all requests for financial assistance and communicate decisions within 2-weeks to the member(s) affected. Decisions are based on available funds of the organization. The Member receiving financial assistance will be responsible for paying the remainder of the class fees, if any, in a timely manner.



Members may also request financial assistance for Co-op field trips and may do so by contacting the Finance Committee Chair.

For questions regarding our Financial Assistance Policy, please email Board@rootsandwingsindy.com.

Expenditures and Reimbursements

Class fees are used to cover any supplies or materials used in classes. Class Leads may purchase materials for their classes and submit a reimbursement form with receipts attached to the Treasurer either as a hard copy or in electronic form. Class Leads must submit reimbursement forms to the Treasurer within one week of the session's end. The Treasurer will pay the reimbursement within one week of receiving the form.

Morning classes have a classroom budget of \$10 per child, per session for the full morning (2 hours). Afternoon classes have a classroom budget of \$5 per child, per session for each afternoon class block (1 hour each). It is the responsibility of the Class Lead to keep class expenses within the given budget. Reimbursement requests over the planned budget for any class or event have no guarantee of reimbursement for the overage amount.

General supplies and other pre-approved expenses may be reimbursed by submitting a reimbursement form with receipts attached to the Treasurer.

Fundraising

All fundraising money will be designated for either the General fund or for the Camp fund.

1. General Fundraising money will be used for field trips, financial assistance, or other special circumstances to be approved by the Board.
2. Camp Fundraising will be used to cover portions of the fees for those Members attending camp.

Members will be notified prior to the fundraising event/effort to which fund the monies will be allocated.

Reports

The Treasurer will report on the financial condition of the co-op, comparing budgeted and actual results, not less than once annually at the final Membership Meeting of the year.



Any Member may review the financial statements of the co-op at any time and will receive the most recent statements one week after a written request is made to the Board Treasurer.

Best Practices

As a small volunteer organization we have the obligation to uphold the culture, integrity, and intent of Roots and Wings Homeschool, while also maintaining flexibility. As such we have and will continue to create best practices for our organization. The intention of these best practices is to hold all of us to the highest standards while allowing a small organization the flexibility needed to function. It should be understood that we will always strive to meet these best practices, however some years it might not be possible to do so.

1. Board Members should not hold liaison positions during their tenure
2. Board Members should not be required to lead teach during their tenure
3. Board Members should not be required to lead special events during their tenure
4. Liaison positions should be vacated each year to allow for new volunteers
5. Year long positions should be spread throughout the many Members of co-op with no one person taking on too many long term roles or responsibilities
6. Sustaining Director, Members of the Best Practices Committee, and other co-op Members should help monitor for burn-out throughout the year and report any issue to board@rootsandwingsindy.com
7. Communication should remain open, clear, and concise throughout the co-op
8. Communications documents and binder should be made available on the google drive, on our website, and as a hard copy in the supply closet at FMC
9. Communications documents and binder should be regularly updated (at least prior to the start of each school year)
10. All Members are welcome to and should email board@rootsandwingsindy.com with any concerns (including but not limited to operational concerns, financial concerns, programming concerns, behavior, bullying, etc)
11. Students shall be placed in their proper morning classes by age as determined by Membership Coordinator



Current Leadership

Board of Directors

- President: Jenna Stensland
- Vice President: Colleen Raymont
- Secretary: Sarah Mihelic
- Treasurer: Jessica Shewan
- Membership: Carrie Sea
- Communications: Erin Bogan
- Sustaining: Katherine Colden

Morning Class Liaisons

- Greenhouse (ages 0-2):
- Saplings: Danielle Bolinger
- Sassafras: Courtney McCracken
- Oaks: Shelly Bergman
- Maples: Lyndsey Newburn
- Birch: Laura Beatus
- Willows: Erin Faya
- Cedars: Amber Furnish
- Pigeons: Dawn Fields

Committee Members

- Safety Coordinator: Kim Hall
- Cleaning Crew Liaison: Parn Sudmee
- Afternoon Class Liaisons: Lyndsey Newburn
- Special Events Liaison: Shan Rubel
- Field Trip Coordinator: Robyn Stano
- Fundraising Coordinator: N/A
- Supply Coordinator: Jody Wilson
- Summer Events Coordinator: TBD

- Parent Events Coordinator: Molly Bellner
- Gratitude/Encouragement Coordinator: Alina Klein
- Welcome Coordinator: Anna Billingsley
- Yearbook Coordinator: Amber Furnish



Password: Educ@t3!

A printer is available for co-op use in the multipurpose room. You must be connected to the Roots & Wings network in order to use it.

Members' Website

<https://www.rootsandwingsindy.com/members>

Links to Documentation

- [Organization's By-Laws](#)
- [Reimbursement Form \(printable\)](#)
- [Reimbursement Form \(online\)](#)
- [Member Agreement and Waiver](#)